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Medium-to-high voltage power system for a transport refrigeration unit

Abstract

A high-voltage system for a transport refrigeration unit (TRU) includes a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source, and a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser, and at least one evaporator. A distribution bus is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/296,335 filed Jan. 4, 2022, all of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) The present disclosure relates to transport refrigeration units, and more specifically, to medium-to-high voltage power systems for a transport refrigeration unit (TRU).

(2) Transport refrigeration units are used to cool cargo in a trailer or cargo container. Existing transport refrigeration units employ an engine and a generator to produce electrical power (e.g., AC power) to drive the compressor and fans (e.g., evaporator fans, condenser fans). Existing sources of AC power produce unregulated AC power that can vary in voltage and frequency. There may be a need for an all-electric solution for providing AC and DC power to the various loads for transport refrigeration units.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION

(3) According to an embodiment, a high-voltage system of a transport refrigeration unit (TRU) is provided. The high-voltage system can include a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source; and a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser, and an at least one evaporator.

(4) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a distribution bus that is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator.

(5) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a first converter that is a DC-DC buck converter configured to step down voltage from the HVDC source, wherein the distribution bus is a low voltage DC bus.

(6) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC motor that is mechanically coupled to an open drive compressor, wherein the evaporator bus and the condenser bus are coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator and the at least one condenser.

(7) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further

embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC motor that is mechanically coupled to an open drive compressor, an evaporator bus that comprises at least one first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus that comprises at least one second DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser, wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC converter are different DC-DC converters.

(8) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC motor that is mechanically coupled to an open drive compressor, an evaporator bus that comprises a DC-DC boost converter coupled to a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus that comprises a DC-DC boost converter coupled to a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser.

(9) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-DC boost converter coupled to a DC-AC converter for the compressor, an evaporator bus and the condenser bus that are coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator and the at least one condenser.

(10) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-DC boost converter coupled to a DC-AC converter for the compressor, an evaporator bus that comprises at least one first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus that comprises at least one second DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser, wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC converter are different DC-DC converters.

(11) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-DC boost converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, an evaporator bus that comprises a DC-DC boost converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, and a condenser bus that comprises a DC-DC boost converter coupled to a DC-AC converter.

(12) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a first converter that is a DC-DC boost converter, wherein the distribution bus is a high-voltage DC distribution bus.

(13) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-DC buck converter coupled to a DC motor that is further mechanically coupled to an open drive compressor, an evaporator bus and the condenser bus that are coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator and the at least one condenser.

(14) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-DC buck converter coupled to a DC motor that is further mechanically coupled to an open drive compressor, an evaporator bus that comprises at least one first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus comprises at least one second DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser, wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC converter are different DC-DC converters.

(15) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC motor and a DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus, a DC motor that is mechanically coupled to an open drive compressor, an evaporator bus that comprises a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus that comprises a DC-AC converter

to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser.

(16) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the compressor, an evaporator bus and the condenser bus that are coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator and the at least one condenser.

(17) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the compressor, an evaporator bus that comprises at least one first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, the condenser bus that comprises at least one second DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser, wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC converter are different DC-DC converters.

(18) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the compressor, an evaporator bus that comprises a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus that comprises a DC-AC converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser.

(19) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a first converter that is a DC-AC converter, wherein the distribution bus is an alternating current (AC) distribution bus.

(20) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a motor and an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-DC buck converter, an evaporator bus and the condenser bus that are coupled to an AC-DC converter coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator and the at least one condenser.

(21) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises a motor and an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-DC buck converter, an evaporator bus that comprises at least one first AC-DC converter coupled to a first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus that comprises at least one second AC-DC converter coupled to a second DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser, wherein the at least one first AC-DC converter and the at least one second AC-DC converter are different AC-DC converters wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC buck converter are different DC-DC buck converters.

(22) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, an evaporator bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, a condenser bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter.

(23) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, an evaporator bus and the condenser bus that are coupled to an AC-DC converter coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator and the at least one condenser.

(24) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, an evaporator bus that comprises at least one first AC-DC converter coupled to a first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator, a condenser bus that comprises at least one second AC-DC converter coupled to a second DC-DC

buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser, wherein the at least one first AC-DC converter and the at least one second AC-DC converter are different AC-DC converters wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC buck converter are different DC-DC buck converters.

(25) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a compressor bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, an evaporator bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, a condenser bus that comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter.

(26) In addition to one or more of the features described herein, or as an alternative, further embodiments include a high-voltage DC source that is between 100-750 volts.

(27) The foregoing features and elements may be combined in various combinations without exclusivity, unless expressly indicated otherwise. These features and elements as well as the operation thereof will become more apparent in light of the following description and the accompanying drawings. It should be understood, however, that the following description and drawings are intended to be illustrative and explanatory in nature and non-limiting.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The following descriptions should not be considered limiting in any way. With reference to the accompanying drawings, like elements are numbered alike:

(2) FIG. 1 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a transport refrigeration unit (TRU) configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(4) FIG. 3 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(5) FIG. 4 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(6) FIG. 5 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(7) FIG. 6 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(8) FIG. 7 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(9) FIG. 8 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(10) FIG. 9 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(11) FIG. 10 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(12) FIG. 11 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(13) FIG. 12 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(14) FIG. 13 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(15) FIG. 14 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-

voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(16) FIG. 15 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(17) FIG. 16 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(18) FIG. 17 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(19) FIG. 18 depicts an exemplary electrical architecture for a TRU configured to receive high-voltage power, in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure; and

(20) FIG. 19 depicts a tractor trailer system having a transport refrigeration unit and a cargo compartment in an exemplary embodiment for implementing an exemplary electrical architecture.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(21) FIG. 1 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **100** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 1, the system **100** utilizes a direct current (DC) source as a source of power. In one or more embodiments of the disclosure, high-voltage can define a range of voltage between 100-750V. In a non-limiting example, the DC source is a high-voltage battery source, i.e., 350 VDC battery.

(22) The distribution network of FIG. 1 can include a DC/DC buck converter that is coupled to the DC source **102**. The DC/DC buck converter can step-down the voltage of the DC source **102** for a distribution bus **104**. As shown in FIG. 1, the distribution bus **104** is a low-voltage DC distribution bus, i.e., 48 VDC bus, that can be coupled to one or more loads such as a motor and/or a DC/DC buck converter. The motor may be mechanically coupled to a compressor **120**, i.e., open drive compressor. The mechanical coupling of the motor to the compressor **120** may comprise any known mechanical coupling.

(23) The DC/DC buck converter is configured to reduce or step-down the voltage provided by the distribution bus **104**. The distribution bus **104** may be coupled to and operable to provide power to a compressor bus **122**, an evaporator bus **124**, and a condenser bus **126**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus may be further coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**. The voltage from the distribution bus **104** is reduced when coupled to the compressor bus **122**, the evaporator bus **124**, and the condenser bus **126** using DC/DC buck converters. In one embodiment of the disclosure, the evaporator bus **124** and the condenser bus **126** are coupled to a single DC/DC buck converter. Each of the compressor bus **122**, evaporator bus **124**, and a condenser bus **126** may be a low voltage bus, i.e., 12 VDC bus, that is operable to provide power to one or more loads such as evaporator fans **112** and condenser fans **114**. In one or more embodiments of the disclosure, the auxiliary unit bus **130** is operable to provide power to an auxiliary unit **116** such as a battery.

(24) FIG. 2 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **200** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 2, the system **200** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary unit **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution network of FIG. 2 can include a distribution bus **210**. The distribution bus **210** may be a low-voltage DC distribution bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC buck converter. The distribution bus **210** may be coupled to a compressor bus **222**, an evaporator bus **224**, and a condenser bus **226**. As shown in FIG. 2, the evaporator bus **224** and the condenser bus **226** are coupled to respective DC/DC buck converters that are independent and different from one another. In different embodiments, the distribution bus may be further coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(25) FIG. 3 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **300** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 3, the system **300** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary unit **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution network of FIG. 3 can include a distribution bus **310**. The distribution bus **310** may be a low-voltage DC distribution bus that is

coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC buck converter. The distribution bus **310** may be coupled to a compressor bus **322**, an evaporator bus **324**, and a condenser bus **326**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus may be further coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(26) The compressor bus **322** can include a motor, where the motor is operably coupled to the compressor **120**. An evaporator bus **324** and a condenser bus **326** can each include a DC/DC boost converter that can be coupled to a DC/AC converter, where the evaporator bus **324** and the condenser bus **326** can be further coupled to the distribution bus **310** through respective DC/DC boost converters. DC/DC boost converters are configured to increase or step-up the 48 VDC to 750 VDC and DC/AC converters are configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC that is provided for the operation of the evaporator fan **112** and the condenser fan **114**, respectively. The auxiliary unit bus **130** may include a DC/DC buck converter to step-down the voltage of the distribution bus **310** to an appropriate voltage for any connected auxiliary units **116**.

(27) FIG. 4 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **400** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 4, the system **400** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary unit **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution network of FIG. 4 can include a distribution bus **410**. The distribution bus **410** may be a low-voltage DC distribution bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC buck converter. The distribution bus **410** may be coupled to a compressor bus **422**, an evaporator bus **424**, and a condenser bus **426**. As shown in FIG. 4, the evaporator bus **424** and the condenser bus **426** are coupled to a single DC/DC buck converter. In different embodiments, the distribution bus may be further coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(28) FIG. 5 depicts an electrical architecture of a system **500** for a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 5, the system **500** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary load **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution bus **510** may be a low-voltage DC distribution bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC buck converter. The distribution network of FIG. 5 may include a distribution bus **510** that is coupled to the compressor bus **522**, the evaporator bus **524**, and the condenser bus **526**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus **510** may further be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(29) The compressor bus **522** can include a DC/DC boost converter that is coupled to a DC/AC converter (inverter). In this non-limiting example, the DC/DC boost converter is configured to increase or step-up the 48 VDC to 750 VDC, and the DC/AC converter is configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC that is provided for the operation of the compressor **120**.

(30) The evaporator bus **524** can include a DC/DC buck converter that is configured to step-down the voltage of the distribution bus **310** from 48 VDC to 12 VDC for the operation of the evaporator fan **112**. Similarly, the condenser bus **526** can include a DC/DC buck converter that is configured to step-down the voltage of the distribution bus **310** from 48 VDC to 12 VDC for the operation of the condenser fan **114**.

(31) FIG. 6 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **600** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 6, the system **600** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary load **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution bus **610** may be a low-voltage DC distribution bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC buck converter. The distribution network of FIG. 6 may be a distribution bus **610** that is coupled to the compressor bus **622**, the evaporator bus **624**, and the condenser bus **626**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus **610** may further be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(32) In one or more embodiments of the disclosure, the compressor bus **622** can include a DC/DC boost converter that is coupled to the DC/AC converter. In this non-limiting example, the DC-DC boost converter is configured to increase the 48 VDC to 750 VDC and the DC/AC converter is

configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC that is provided for the operation of the compressor **120**.

(33) Similarly, the evaporator bus **624** and the condenser bus **626** each include a DC-DC boost converter that is coupled to a DC/AC converter. In this non-limiting example, each DC-DC boost converter is configured to increase or step-up the 48 VDC to 750 VDC and each DC/AC converter is configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to operate the evaporator fan **112** and the condenser fan **114**, respectively.

(34) FIG. 7 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **700** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 7, the system **700** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary unit **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution network of FIG. 7 can include a distribution bus **710**. The distribution bus **710** may be a high-voltage DC distribution bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC boost converter. The distribution bus **710** may be coupled to a compressor bus **722**, an evaporator bus **724**, and a condenser bus **726**. As shown in FIG. 7, the evaporator bus **724** and the condenser bus **726** are coupled to a single DC-DC buck converter. In different embodiments, the distribution bus may be further coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(35) FIG. 8 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **800** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. 8 can include a DC/DC boost converter that is coupled to the DC source **102**. The DC/DC boost converter can step-up the voltage of the DC source **102** for a distribution bus **810**. The distribution bus **810** may be a high-voltage DC distribution bus, and may be coupled to the compressor bus **822**, the evaporator bus **824**, and the condenser bus **826**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus **810** may further be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(36) The compressor bus can include a DC/DC buck converter coupled to a motor used to drive a compressor **120**. The DC/DC buck converter can be configured to step-down the voltage of the high-voltage DC distribution bus. The evaporator bus **824** can include a DC/DC buck converter to step-down the voltage of the high-voltage DC distribution bus to a lower DC voltage for operation of the evaporator fan **112**. Similarly, the condenser bus **826** may comprise DC/DC buck converter to step-down the voltage of the high-voltage DC distribution bus to a lower DC voltage for operation of the condenser fan **114**.

(37) FIG. 9 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **900** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. 9 can include a DC/DC boost converter that is coupled to the DC source **102**. The distribution bus **910** may be a high-voltage DC distribution bus, and may be coupled to the compressor bus **922**, the evaporator bus **924**, and the condenser bus **926**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus **910** may further be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(38) The compressor bus **922** may comprise a DC/DC buck converter coupled to a motor used to drive a compressor **120**. The DC/DC buck converter can be configured to step-down the voltage of the high-voltage DC distribution bus. The evaporator bus **924** can include a DC/AC converter to convert the voltage of the high-voltage DC distribution bus. For example, the DC/AC converter can be configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to operate the evaporator fan **112**. Similarly, the condenser bus **926** can include a DC/AC converter to convert the power of the high-voltage DC distribution bus. For example, the DC/AC converter can be configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to operate the condenser fan **114**.

(39) FIG. 10 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1000** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 10, the system **1000** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary unit **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution network of FIG. 10 can include a distribution bus **1010**. The distribution bus **1010** may be a high-voltage DC distribution

bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC boost converter. The distribution bus **1010** may be coupled to a compressor bus **1022**, an evaporator bus **1024**, and a condenser bus **1026**. As shown in FIG. **10**, the evaporator bus **1024** and the condenser bus **1026** are coupled to a single DC/DC buck converter. In different embodiments, the distribution bus may be further coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(40) FIG. **11** depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1100** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. **11** can include a DC/DC boost converter that is coupled to the DC source **102**. The distribution bus **1110** may be a high-voltage DC distribution bus and may be coupled to the compressor bus **1122**, the evaporator bus **1124**, and the condenser bus **1126**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus **1110** may further be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(41) The compressor bus **1122** can include a DC/AC converter that is configured to convert the voltage of the distribution bus **1110** for the operation of the compressor **120**. For example, the DC/AC converter can be configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to operate the compressor **120**. The evaporator bus **1124** and the condenser bus **1126** can be coupled to the distribution bus **1110** through respective DC/DC buck converters. The evaporator bus **1124** and the condenser bus **1126** provide lower DC voltage for operation of the evaporator fan **112** and the condenser fan **114**, respectively. In other embodiments, the second distribution bus is further operable to provide power to an auxiliary unit **116**.

(42) FIG. **12** depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1200** for a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. **12** can include a DC/DC boost converter that is coupled to the DC source **102**. The distribution bus **1210** may be a high-voltage DC distribution bus, and may be coupled to the compressor bus **1222**, the evaporator bus **1224**, and the condenser bus **1226**. In different embodiments, the distribution bus **1210** may further be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(43) The compressor bus **1222** can include a DC/AC converter for the operation of the compressor **120**. The DC/AC converter is configured to convert the voltage of the distribution bus **1210**. For example, the DC/AC converter can be configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to operate the compressor **120**.

(44) The evaporator bus **1224** can include a DC/AC converter to convert the voltage of the high-voltage DC distribution bus. For example, the DC/AC converter can be configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to operate the evaporator fan **112**. Similarly, the condenser bus **1226** can include a DC/AC converter to convert the voltage of the high-voltage DC distribution bus. For example, the DC/AC converter can be configured to convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to operate the condenser fan **114**.

(45) FIG. **13** depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1300** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. **13**, the system **1300** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary unit **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. **1**. The distribution network of FIG. **13** can include a distribution bus **1310**. The distribution bus **1310** may be a high-voltage AC distribution bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC/AC converter. The distribution bus **1310** may be coupled to a compressor bus **1322**, an evaporator bus **1324**, and a condenser bus **1326**.

(46) The compressor bus **1322** may comprise an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/DC buck converter that is further coupled to a motor. The AC/DC converter may be configured to convert the high-voltage AC from the distribution **1310** to DC voltage and the DC/DC buck converter may be operable to step-down the DC voltage, i.e., 48 VDC, to a voltage that is appropriate to operate the motor of the compressor.

(47) The evaporator bus **1324** and the condenser bus **1326** are coupled to high voltage AC distribution bus through the same AC/DC converter and DC/DC buck converter.

(48) FIG. 14 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1400** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. 14 can include a converter that is coupled to the DC power source **102** and a distribution bus **1410**. The converter may comprise a DC/DC/AC converter that is operable to convert the voltage from the DC power source **102** to high-voltage AC for distribution to various loads over a distribution bus **1410**. The various loads may include such loads as the evaporator fan **112**, the condenser fan **114**, the auxiliary unit **116**, and the compressor **120** shown in FIG. 1.

(49) The distribution bus **1410** may be a high-voltage AC distribution bus, i.e., 480 VAC. The distribution bus **1410** may be coupled to a compressor bus **1422**, an evaporator bus **1424**, and a condenser bus **1426**. In a further embodiment, the distribution bus **1410** may be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130** including, for example, a battery charger that is operable to charge a connected battery.

(50) The compressor bus **1422** may comprise an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/DC buck converter that is further coupled to a motor. The AC/DC converter may be configured to convert the high-voltage AC from the distribution **1410** to DC voltage and the DC/DC buck converter may be operable to step-down the DC voltage, i.e., 48 VDC, to a voltage that is appropriate to operate the motor of the compressor.

(51) The evaporator bus **1424** and the condenser bus **1426** may each comprise an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/DC buck converter to condition the power to operate the evaporator fan **112** and the condenser fan **114**, respectively.

(52) FIG. 15 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1500** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. 15 can include a converter that is coupled to the DC power source **102** and distribution bus **1510**. The converter may comprise a DC/DC/AC converter that is operable to convert the voltage from the DC power source **102** to high-voltage AC for distribution to various loads over a distribution bus **1510**. The first stage of the DC/DC/AC converter can step-up the voltage of the DC source **102** to the appropriate level and then convert the DC to AC for the distribution bus **1510**. The various loads may include such loads as the evaporator fan **112**, the condenser fan **114**, the auxiliary unit **116**, and the compressor **120** shown in FIG. 1.

(53) The distribution bus **1510** may be a high-voltage AC distribution bus, i.e., 480 VAC, and may be coupled to a compressor bus **1522**, an evaporator bus **1524**, and a condenser bus **1526**. In a further embodiment, the distribution bus **1510** may be coupled to an auxiliary unit bus **130** including, for example, a battery charger that is operable to charge a connected battery.

(54) The compressor bus **1522** may comprise an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/DC buck converter that is further coupled to a motor. The AC/DC converter may be configured to convert the high-voltage AC from the distribution **1510** to DC voltage and the DC/DC buck converter may be operable to step-down the DC voltage, i.e., 48 VDC, to a voltage that is appropriate to operate the motor of the compressor. The evaporator bus **1524** and condenser bus **1526** can each include an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/AC converter. The AC/DC converter may convert the 480 VAC from the distribution bus to 750 VDC and the DC/AC converter may convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to provide power to operate the connected refrigerated equipment.

(55) FIG. 16 depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1600** using a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. As shown in FIG. 16, the system **1600** includes the DC source **102** and similar loads (evaporator fan **112**, condenser fan **114**, auxiliary unit **116**, compressor **120**) as shown in FIG. 1. The distribution network of FIG. 16 can include a distribution bus **1610**. The distribution bus **1610** may be a low-voltage DC distribution bus that is coupled to the DC source **102** through the DC/DC buck converter. The distribution bus **1610** may be coupled to a compressor bus **1622**, an evaporator bus **1624**, and a condenser bus **1626**. As shown in FIG. 16, the evaporator bus and the condenser bus are coupled to the same DC/DC buck converter. In different embodiments, the distribution bus may be further coupled to an

auxiliary unit bus **130**.

(56) FIG. **17** depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1700** using high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. **17** can include a converter that is coupled to the DC power source **102** and a distribution bus **1710**. The converter may comprise a DC/DC/AC converter that is operable to convert the power from the DC power source **102** to high-voltage AC for distribution to various loads over a distribution bus **1710**. The various loads may include such loads as the evaporator fan **112**, the condenser fan **114**, the auxiliary unit **116**, and the compressor **120** shown in FIG. **1**.

(57) The distribution bus **1710** may be a high-voltage AC distribution bus. The distribution bus **1710** of FIG. **12** may be coupled to a compressor bus **1722**, an evaporator bus **1724**, and a condenser bus **1726**. The compressor bus **1722** can include an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/AC converter. The AC/DC converter may convert the 480 VAC from the distribution bus to 750 VDC and the DC/AC converter may convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to provide power to operate the compressor **120**.

(58) The evaporator bus **1724** and the condenser bus **1726** may each comprise an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/DC buck converter to condition the power to operate the evaporator fan **112** and the condenser fan **114**, respectively.

(59) FIG. **18** depicts an electrical architecture for a system **1800** having a high-voltage power source in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The distribution network of FIG. **18** can include a converter that is coupled to the DC power source **102** and a distribution bus **1810**. The converter may comprise a DC/DC/AC converter that is operable to convert the power from the DC power source **102** to high-voltage AC for distribution to various loads over a distribution bus **1810**. The various loads may include such loads as the evaporator fan **112**, the condenser fan **114**, the auxiliary unit **116**, and the compressor **120** shown in FIG. **1**.

(60) The distribution bus **1810** may be a high-voltage AC distribution bus, and may be coupled to a compressor bus **1822**, an evaporator bus **1824**, and a condenser bus **1826**. The compressor bus can include an AC/DC converter that is coupled to a DC/AC converter. The AC/DC converter may convert the 480 VAC from the distribution bus to 750 VDC and the DC/AC converter may convert the 750 VDC to 460 VAC to provide power to operate the compressor **120**. Similarly, the evaporator bus **1824** and the condenser bus **1826** each comprise an AC/DC converter to convert the AC voltage from the distribution bus to a DC voltage and a DC/AC converter to convert the DC voltage from the AC/DC converter to operate the connected refrigeration equipment.

(61) Shown in FIG. **19** is an embodiment of a tractor trailer system **100** for implementing one or more of the electrical architectures discussed with reference to FIGS. **1-18**. The tractor trailer system **1900** includes a tractor **1902** including an operator's compartment or cab **1904** and also including an engine, which acts as the drive system of the tractor trailer system **1900**. A trailer **1906** is coupled to the tractor **1902**. The trailer **1906** is a refrigerated trailer **1906** and includes a top wall **1908**, a directly opposed bottom wall **1910**, opposed side walls **1912**, and a front wall **1914**, with the front wall **1914** being closest to the tractor **1902**. The trailer **1906** further includes a door or doors (not shown) at a rear wall **1916**, opposite the front wall **1914**. The walls of the trailer **1906** define a cargo compartment. The trailer **1906** is configured to maintain a cargo **1918** located inside the cargo compartment at a selected temperature through the use of a transport refrigeration unit **120** located on the trailer **1906**. The transport refrigeration unit **1920**, as shown in FIG. **19**, is located at or attached to the front wall **1914**.

(62) A detailed description of one or more embodiments of the disclosed apparatus and method are presented herein by way of exemplification and not limitation with reference to the Figures.

(63) The term “about” is intended to include the degree of error associated with measurement of the particular quantity based upon the equipment available at the time of filing the application.

(64) The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only and is not intended to be limiting of the present disclosure. As used herein, the singular forms “a”, “an”

and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms “comprises” and/or “comprising,” when used in this specification, specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, element components, and/or groups thereof.

(65) While the present disclosure has been described with reference to an exemplary embodiment or embodiments, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes may be made and equivalents may be substituted for elements thereof without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. In addition, many modifications may be made to adapt a particular situation or material to the teachings of the present disclosure without departing from the essential scope thereof. Therefore, it is intended that the present disclosure not be limited to the particular embodiment disclosed as the best mode contemplated for carrying out this present disclosure, but that the present disclosure will include all embodiments falling within the scope of the claims.

Claims

1. A high-voltage system of a transport refrigeration unit (TRU), the system comprising: a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source; a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser fan, and at least one evaporator fan; wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser fan, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator fan; wherein the first converter is a DC-AC converter, wherein the distribution bus is an alternating current (AC) distribution bus; wherein the compressor bus comprises a motor and an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-DC buck converter, wherein the evaporator bus and the condenser bus are coupled to an AC-DC converter coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator fan and the at least one condenser fan.

2. The high-voltage system of claim 1, wherein the high-voltage DC source is between 100-750 volts.

3. A high-voltage system of a transport refrigeration unit (TRU), the system comprising: a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source; a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser fan, and at least one evaporator fan; wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser fan, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator fan; wherein the first converter is a DC-AC converter, wherein the distribution bus is an alternating current (AC) distribution bus; wherein the compressor bus comprises a motor and an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-DC buck converter, wherein the evaporator bus comprises at least one first AC-DC converter coupled to a first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator fan, wherein the condenser bus comprises at least one second AC-DC converter coupled to a second DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser fan, wherein the at least one first AC-DC converter and the at least one second AC-DC converter are different AC-DC converters wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC buck converter are different DC-DC buck converters.

4. A high-voltage system of a transport refrigeration unit (TRU), the system comprising: a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source; a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser fan, and at least one evaporator fan; wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser fan, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator fan; wherein the first converter is a DC-AC converter,

wherein the distribution bus is an alternating current (AC) distribution bus; wherein the compressor bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, wherein the evaporator bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, wherein the condenser bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter.

5. A high-voltage system of a transport refrigeration unit (TRU), the system comprising: a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source; a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser fan, and at least one evaporator fan; wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser fan, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator fan; wherein the first converter is a DC-AC converter, wherein the distribution bus is an alternating current (AC) distribution bus; wherein the compressor bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, wherein the evaporator bus and the condenser bus are coupled to an AC-DC converter coupled to at least one DC-DC buck converter that is used to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator fan and the at least one condenser fan.

6. A high-voltage system of a transport refrigeration unit (TRU), the system comprising: a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source; a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser fan, and at least one evaporator fan; wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser fan, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator fan; wherein the first converter is a DC-AC converter, wherein the distribution bus is an alternating current (AC) distribution bus; wherein the compressor bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, wherein the evaporator bus comprises at least one first AC-DC converter coupled to a first DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one evaporator fan, wherein the condenser bus comprises at least one second AC-DC converter coupled to a second DC-DC buck converter to convert voltage from the distribution bus for the at least one condenser fan, wherein the at least one first AC-DC converter and the at least one second AC-DC converter are different AC-DC converters wherein the at least one first DC-DC buck converter and the at least one second DC-DC buck converter are different DC-DC buck converters.

7. A high-voltage system of a transport refrigeration unit (TRU), the system comprising: a high-voltage direct current (HVDC) source; a first converter coupling the HVDC source to a distribution bus, wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor, at least one condenser fan, and at least one evaporator fan; wherein the distribution bus is coupled to a compressor bus coupled to the compressor, a condenser bus coupled to the at least one condenser fan, and an evaporator bus coupled to the at least one evaporator fan; wherein the first converter is a DC-AC converter, wherein the distribution bus is an alternating current (AC) distribution bus; wherein the compressor bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, wherein the evaporator bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter, wherein the condenser bus comprises an AC-DC converter coupled to a DC-AC converter.
